FreshWay — Department file: Orderpicking

Smart Logistics (EDSLOG.24) · autumn 2026

This is **your department's file**. Every department has one; you only receive your own. If you need a figure from a neighbouring department, ask them — that is what the Data Council and the Interface Agreements are for.

Alongside this file you have the **public Company dossier** (the company as a whole, the network, the cost structure, the IT landscape), which everyone has. Anything in neither document can be requested from the Executive Board with an **Information Request**; the *Board archive index* lists what exists.

Units matter. Shrink appears twice in this company: in **kilograms** against purchase volume, and in **euros** at cost. They are different numbers. Every figure below says which.

Read the KPI table with this in mind. Every KPI carries a label:

Label	Meaning
measure	not printed here on purpose — this value is in the dataset you receive in lesson 3. Measuring it is part of your work, and a department that reports its own KPI without having measured it will be asked how it knows.
N	a **norm**: what the company has set as its target. A norm is policy, not a measurement — you may argue it is wrong.
S	a **design assumption**: plausible, internally consistent, not measured. If you build a business case on it, say so.

Almost every "now" value sits below its norm. That is deliberate: a company that already meets all its targets gives you nothing to design for.

What we do. Picking store orders and consumer orders: roll cages for stores in the three DCs, crates for home delivery in the EFC.

Volumes	Value	Unit
Case picks, store orders	**97 mln per year** · ~311,000 per day	cases

Volumes	Value	Unit
Pick lines, e-commerce	**107 mln per year** · ~343,000 per day	lines
Roll cages built	6,220	per day
Crates built	~24,570 per day · 7.7 mln per year	crates
Pick rate, CDC (mechanised)	~700	cases/hour
Pick rate, RDC (voice, manual)	~400	cases/hour
Pick rate, EFC (goods-to-person)	~250	lines/hour

KPI	Now	Target
Pick error rate	**0.30% of lines**	0.15%
Order fill rate, online	96.5%	98%
Orders completed within the cut-off	*measure*	**99%** · N
Damage caused in picking	*measure*	**< 0.10% of lines** · N

Systems. WMS with voice picking in the regional DCs, mechanised shuttle and palletising in the CDC via a closed WCS/WES, goods-to-person in the EFC. *What they do not do:* the sequence in which a crate is built is not linked to how it has to be unpacked at the customer's door, and consumer picking competes with store picking for the same people without a priority rule.

People. ~595 DC headcount (~480 FTE) plus ~450 in the EFC (~300 FTE); 18% agency, 30% in peaks. **Cost per unit:** inside the €0.50 per case warehousing cost; e-fulfilment picking is **€5 per order** (€13 mln per year).

Our main problems.

1. **Our error rate is not flat and we have never explained it.** On some days we pick nearly twice as many errors as on others, and picking takes measurably longer on those same days. The explanation we always reach for is agency staff — we run 18% agency and up to 30% in peak weeks — but nobody has ever checked whether the bad days are actually the agency-heavy days.
2. We build crates for freshness by habit, not by specification — nobody has told us what the promise at the door actually is.

3. A basket with 42 lines costs us far more than the case picking behind a store delivery, and nothing in the online shop reflects that. Our error rate is twice the target and we do not know which of the two flows causes it.

What we send / receive. *To Outbound transport:* completed roll cages per store and per delivery window. *To Delivery to consumers:* completed crates per order, with cold packs. *From E-commerce:* the order profile and the cut-off times. **Data we hold but do not use:** pick time and error rate per hour of the day and per day of the week, two years deep — never once plotted against the arrival pattern of the goods.

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*Figures come from the FreshWay figure sheet. Fields marked **measure** are in the data you receive in lesson 3. The problems in the list above are real and traceable in that data; if you cannot find them, you are looking in the wrong place or joining the wrong sets — and some of them cannot be found from your own data alone.*

> **GenAI transparency.** This department file was written with Claude (Anthropic) by the course team, based on the FreshWay case design and on verified benchmark research into Dutch grocery retail. All figures come from a separate, source-checked figure sheet; none were generated by the model. Human-AI Agency Label: **Co-Creator**. Label source: Boetje, J., & Baake, G. (2026). *Nine prototypical human-AI agency patterns* [Figure]. figshare. https://doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.31706884 (CC BY 4.0).
